GOOGLE SETUP GUIDE

V E L A

P R I V A T E C O M M A N D I N F R A S T R U C T U R E

Google Setup Guide

How to authorize Hannah to access your Gmail, Calendar, and Drive.
Do this the day before your installation call.

Your judgment. Our infrastructure.

Pre-Installation · Takes about 20 minutes · March 2026

GOOGLE SETUP GUIDE

Hannah needs permission to read your Gmail, check your calendar, and save documents to your Google Drive. Google requires you to authorize this access through a process called OAuth. You do this once — the installer handles everything from there.

By the end of this guide you will have one file and one number to bring to the installation call:

What	Looks Like	Where to Store It
client_secret_XXXX.json	A file in your Downloads folder	Move to your Desktop. Treat like a password.
Google Drive Folder ID	A long string of letters and numbers	Save in your password manager

> Do this the day before your installation call — not the morning of. If something looks unfamiliar or you get stuck, message Greg before the call. Do not wait until you are on the call to start this.

1 Create Your Google Cloud Project

5 minutes — do this first

1 Go to the Google Cloud Console

Open a browser (Chrome or Safari) and go to this address:

→ **console.cloud.google.com**

Sign in with the Gmail account you want Hannah to use — the one where your important email lives.

2 Open the project picker

Look at the very top of the page, right next to the Google Cloud logo on the left. You will see a button that says either "Select a project" or shows a project name with a small down arrow next to it.

→ **Click that button**

A popup window appears showing your existing projects (if any).

3 Create a new project

In the top-right corner of that popup window, look for the button that says New Project.

→ **Click New Project**

4	**Name your project** A form appears with one field: Project Name. → **Type: VELA**

Leave everything else as it is. Do not change the organization or location fields.

→ **Click the blue CREATE button at the bottom**

Wait about 10 seconds for the project to be created. The page will reload.

5	**Confirm VELA is your active project** After the page reloads, click the project picker button at the top again. You should see VELA in the list. Click on it to make it active. → **VELA should now appear in the top bar next to the Google Cloud logo**

If you see VELA in the top bar, your project is active and you are ready for Part 2.

2 Enable the Three APIs

5 minutes — turn on Gmail, Calendar, and Drive

You need to turn on three Google services that Hannah will use. You do this one at a time in the API Library.

6	**Open the navigation menu** Look at the very top-left corner of the screen. You will see three horizontal lines (≡) — this is the main menu button. → **Click the ≡ menu icon**

A navigation panel slides out from the left side.

7	**Go to the API Library** In the navigation panel, scroll down until you see APIs & Services. Click it. A submenu appears. → **Click APIs & Services → Library**

You are now in the API Library — a page with a large search bar and a list of Google services.

8	**Enable the Gmail API** Click in the search bar at the top of the API Library page. → **Type: Gmail API**

A result appears called Gmail API with a red envelope icon. Click on it. You land on a page describing the Gmail API.

→ **Click the blue ENABLE button**

Wait for the page to confirm it is enabled. You will see a green checkmark or the button changes to MANAGE.

Click the back arrow in your browser to return to the API Library.

9	**Enable the Google Calendar API** You are back in the API Library. Click in the search bar again. → **Type: Google Calendar API**

Click the Google Calendar API result. Click the blue ENABLE button. Click the back arrow to return to the Library.

10	**Enable the Google Drive API** Click in the search bar one more time. → **Type: Google Drive API**

Click the Google Drive API result. Click the blue ENABLE button.

> All three APIs are now enabled. To confirm: click APIs & Services → Enabled APIs in the left menu. You should see Gmail API, Google Calendar API, and Google Drive API all listed.

3 Configure the OAuth Consent Screen

5 minutes — tell Google what this app is

Before you can create credentials, Google needs basic information about what is requesting access. This takes a few minutes and you only do it once.

11 Open the OAuth consent screen

In the left navigation, click APIs & Services. In the submenu that appears, click OAuth consent screen.

→ **Click APIs & Services → OAuth consent screen**

12 Select External user type

Google asks you to choose between Internal and External. Select External.

→ **Click External → Click CREATE**

A longer form appears. You only need to fill in three fields.

13 Fill in the required fields

The form has many fields. Fill in only these three — leave everything else blank:

Field	What to Type
App name	VELA
User support email	Your Gmail address (click the dropdown — it appears automatically)
Developer contact information (at the very bottom of the page)	Your Gmail address again

→ **Click SAVE AND CONTINUE**

Do not worry about the other fields. Leave them blank.

14 Skip the Scopes screen

The next screen is titled Scopes. You do not need to add anything here.

→ **Click SAVE AND CONTINUE**

15	**Add yourself as a test user** The next screen is titled Test users. Click the ADD USERS button. → **Click ADD USERS**

A small text field appears. Type your Gmail address and press Enter. Your address appears in the list.

→ **Click ADD → then click SAVE AND CONTINUE**

16	**Return to the dashboard** You see a Summary screen. You do not need to read it. → **Click BACK TO DASHBOARD**

4 Create Your OAuth Credentials

5 minutes — the most important part

This is where most people get confused. Read each step carefully before clicking.

17 Go to the Credentials page

In the left navigation, click APIs & Services → Credentials.

→ **Click APIs & Services → Credentials**

You see a page with a + CREATE CREDENTIALS button near the top.

18 Start creating an OAuth client ID

Click the + CREATE CREDENTIALS button. A dropdown menu appears with several options.

→ **Click + CREATE CREDENTIALS → Click OAuth client ID**

19 Select Desktop app as the application type

A form appears. The first field is Application type with a dropdown.

→ **Click the Application type dropdown → Select Desktop app**

20 Name your credential

In the Name field below the application type:

→ **Type: VELA Desktop**

→ **Click the blue CREATE button**

A popup window appears. Do not close it yet.

! The Download Button — Do Not Miss This

It is easy to overlook and hard to find again

A popup titled OAuth client created appears on your screen. It shows two long strings of text — your Client ID and your Client Secret. You do not need to copy these manually.

Look at the bottom of this popup. There are two buttons:

Button	Where It Is	What to Do
CANCEL	Bottom left	Do NOT click this yet
DOWNLOAD JSON ↓	Bottom right — may show as a small download arrow icon	Click THIS one first

→ **Click DOWNLOAD JSON (bottom-right of the popup)**

A file named client_secret_XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX.json downloads to your Downloads folder. This is your credential file. Once you click OK to close the popup, this button is gone — the file is much harder to retrieve later.

21 **Close the popup**

After the file has downloaded, close the popup.

→ **Click OK**

22 **Move the file somewhere safe**

Open your Downloads folder. Find the file named client_secret_XXXX.json. Move it to your Desktop so you can find it easily during the installation call.

→ **Move client_secret_XXXX.json to your Desktop**

This file contains credentials that give access to your Gmail, Calendar, and Drive. Treat it like a password. Do not email it, share it, or put it in a cloud folder. Your installer will use it during the installation call and then it stays on your Mac Mini only.

5 Create Your Google Drive Backup Folder

2 minutes

VELA backs up your entire configuration to Google Drive automatically every night. You need to create a folder for those backups and give your installer the folder ID.

23 Go to Google Drive

Open a new browser tab and go to:

→ **drive.google.com**

Sign in with the same Gmail account you used for the Google Cloud project.

24 Create a new folder

Look at the left side of the screen. Near the top, there is a + New button.

→ **Click + New → Click New Folder**

A small dialog appears asking for a folder name.

→ **Type: VELA Backups → Click CREATE**

25 Open the folder

You will see the VELA Backups folder appear in your Drive. Double-click it to open it.

→ **Double-click VELA Backups to open it**

26 Copy the Folder ID from the URL

Look at the address bar in your browser. The URL looks like this:

https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1ABC123xyzDEF456ghiJKL

The Folder ID is the long string of characters at the very end of the URL — everything after /folders/. In the example above, the Folder ID is:

`1ABC123xyzDEF456ghiJKL`

Select that string in your browser's address bar and copy it. Paste it into your password manager and label it VELA Backups Folder ID.

✓ You're Done — Final Checklist

Before your installation call, confirm you have all of these:

- ☐ client_secret_XXXX.json file is on your Desktop
- ☐ Google Drive Folder ID is saved in your password manager
- ☐ Gmail API is enabled in Google Cloud Console
- ☐ Google Calendar API is enabled in Google Cloud Console
- ☐ Google Drive API is enabled in Google Cloud Console
- ☐ Your Gmail address was added as a test user on the OAuth consent screen

Bring the JSON file and the Folder ID to the installation call. Your installer handles everything else from there. If anything in this guide looked different from what you expected, message Greg before the call — not during it.

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? If Something Looks Different

Google updates its console interface regularly. If a menu, button, or page looks different from what this guide describes, here is how to find your way:

If you see this...	Do this
"Google Auth Platform" instead of "APIs & Services"	Same thing — use Google Auth Platform. The steps are identical.
A different consent screen layout	Fill in App name, support email, and developer contact. Skip everything else.
The Download JSON button is missing after creating credentials	Go back to APIs & Services → Credentials. Find your credential in the list. Click the download icon (↓) on the right side of the row.
"This app isn't verified" warning during the install	Click Advanced → Go to VELA (unsafe). This is expected for a new project that hasn't been reviewed by Google. It is safe.
You closed the popup before downloading the JSON	Go to APIs & Services → Credentials. Find VELA Desktop in the OAuth 2.0 Client IDs list. Click the download icon (↓) on the far right of that row.